
[← Back to the home page](#)

Bus

How Taipei's joint-operation bus network is numbered, coloured and paid for.

Network

The joint-operation system — one brand, one fare structure, many private companies — and the route numbering that encodes more than it appears to.

The joint-operation network

Around 280 routes, fourteen private companies and one brand. Four city regulations set out how the money actually moves — and the central revenue pool everyone repeats is in none of them.

Nothing here yet. This section is planned for the second version of the site, and it is listed now rather than hidden because leaving it out would misrepresent what the site is for: the bus network carries a large share of Taipei's daily journeys, and a guide that quietly stopped at rail would be a metro guide calling itself a transit guide.

What it will cover

The network itself, before anything else. Taipei's city buses run as 聯營公車 — a joint operation. Private companies operate under one fare structure, one numbering scheme and one brand, so that to a passenger it looks like a single network when it is not. That structural fact is the most valuable thing this section can explain, almost no English source states it, and it is why Network `[/bus/network/]` sits above the operator and route pages rather than below them.

Operators. More than a dozen companies work the network under contract, each with its own fleet, liveries and garages. The relationships between them — including who owns whom — are poorly documented in English, which makes this the part most likely to be worth reading rather than merely present.

Routes. The trunk corridors to begin with — the numbered services and the bus lanes along Zhongxiao, Renai, Xinyi and Nanjing — rather than attempting the lot. Taipei City and New Taipei between them run several hundred routes, and a few hundred stub pages would be worth less than twenty written ones. The route *numbering system* itself needs an explainer before any route page makes sense.

Vehicles and garages. Fleet lists exist through enthusiast sources and operator publications; they churn constantly, which is why [Models](#) and [Garages](#) wait for a data pipeline rather than a transcription.

Fares and payment. Section-based fares, the EasyCard transfer discount between bus and metro, and where the section boundaries actually fall — which is the thing visitors get wrong most often.

Why it is not written yet

Because the rail side is not finished. Starting a second section before the first is sound would produce two half-guides instead of one good one, and the Wenhua Line pages are still stubs carrying figures marked *TBC*.

There is also a sourcing problem specific to buses that rail does not have. Metro station data comes from MOTC's open data platform: authoritative, stable, and slow to change. Bus route data is published per-operator and per-municipality, changes far more often, and the English-language versions of it go out of date quickly. Covering it honestly needs a data pipeline rather than a transcription, and building one before there is anything to put through it would be the wrong order of work.

See [about](#) for how this site sources material, and the [network](#) for what is covered today.

An independent, non-commercial reference site. Not affiliated with Taipei Rapid Transit Corporation, Taipei City Government, or any bus operator. Line colours are the official values published by each operator through Taiwan MOTC's open data platform. [About this site](#).

Station names, codes and sequence from TDX Transport Data eXchange, Ministry of Transportation and Communications, operator TRTC. Government open data. Retrieved 2026-08-10; source last updated 2020-01-31. Provenance.